



Dr. Sanjay Agarwal: Architecting India's Infrastructure Renaissance

In an industry defined by concrete and steel, Dr. Sanjay Agarwal has built a legacy that transcends physical structures to reshape India's infrastructure paradigm. His four-decade journey from railway engineer to visionary advisor offers a masterclass in leadership that balances technical expertise with unwavering ethical principles.

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In the high-stakes arena of infrastructure development, few leaders have shaped India's landscape with the vision and tenacity of Dr. Sanjay Agarwal. From his humble beginnings in Gorakhpur to founding SA Associates in 2024, Agarwal's 38-year journey stands as a testament to engineering excellence and ethical leadership.

"Infrastructure is the backbone of any developing nation," says the Manipal Institute of Technology alumnus whose career trajectory has been nothing short of remarkable. Beginning as an Assistant Project Manager at IRCON in 1986, Agarwal contributed to transformative projects including Asia's largest Rail Coach Factory in Kapurthala before expanding his horizons internationally.

His tenure with Malaysia's PILECON Geotechnics Bhd exposed him to specialized construction methodologies, including Kuala Lumpur's first high-rise building utilizing top-down construction. This international exposure proved invaluable when he joined IJM Corporation in 1996, eventually

returning to spearhead IJM India Infrastructure Ltd's ambitious ventures.

The true inflection point in Agarwal's career came in 2008 with the establishment of Team Universal Infratech Pvt. Ltd. (TUIPL). Under his stewardship, TUIPL achieved a remarkable turnover of ₹2,200 crore within 14 years before being acquired by IJM Corporation in 2019—a full-circle moment in his professional journey.

Agarwal's imprint on India's infrastructure is most visible in the highway sector, where he has overseen the development of more than 5,000 lane kilometers since 1999. His team set a world record by laying 25.54 kilometers of road in just 17 hours and 45 minutes for the Solapur-Bijapur project—engineering efficiency at its finest.

Beyond technical achievements, Agarwal's leadership philosophy emphasizes human capital. During the COVID-19 pandemic, with 2,000 workers stranded at project sites, his management approach transcended business metrics to focus on human welfare. This experience reinforced his conviction that ethical leadership

and decisive action are non-negotiable pillars of success.

"True success comes from uplifting others, not pushing them down to elevate ourselves," Agarwal emphasizes, a philosophy that guides his sustainability initiatives, including tree transplantation technology and biodiesel utilization in equipment.

Despite stepping down from executive responsibilities in April 2024, Agarwal continues his industry contribution through SA Associates, offering advisory services, mentorship, and strategic networking to infrastructure players. As Director and Advisor to IJM, his focus remains on cultivating future leaders who prioritize stakeholder value, accountability, and ethical decision-making.

For emerging industry leaders, Agarwal's advice is crystallized in three principles: maintain unwavering integrity, communicate effectively, and make decisive choices. In his words, the infrastructure sector's future depends not just on technical innovation but on leadership that balances ethics with excellence—the true foundation of India's infrastructural renaissance.